

W H A L E C L A S S

Circle Time Guide

Everything you need, one page per day

The Earth

Week 29

Week of Apr 12–16

13 minutes a day

ages 2.5–6

English learners





Week 29 · Week Overview

The Earth
Print · laminate · ring-bind · hold this all week

5 words they'll own by Friday →

Earth

land

water

home

round

The globe comes out on Monday and stays out for the whole of April — Earth Day is 22 April, in Week 30's window; Friday announces it.

Littles (2.5–3)

One word + a gesture is a win: **"Earth!"** (hug a big ball), **"Water!"** (one wavy hand), **"Land!"** (flat palm slaps the floor).

Bigs (4–6)

Sentence frames: **"This is the Earth."**

"I live on the Earth."

"The Earth is round."

"Is it land or water?"

The week at a glance

MON	Our Round Earth	the globe in the Magic Box (the biggest one in the school)
TUE	Land Under My Feet	a jar of real soil in the Magic Box, lid off
WED	Water All Around	a clear bowl of water with a little boat floating on it in the Magic Box
THU	The Earth Is Home	the Montessori sandpaper globe in the Magic Box
FRI	Round and Round + Review	everything from the week back in the Magic Box

2 MIN

Magic Box hook



4 MIN

Teach the words



3 MIN

Song · today's verse



3 MIN

Game · move it



1 MIN

Whisper-shout close

Weekly rituals — use these every single day

Attention grabber: Teacher: **"One, two, three — eyes on me!"** · Kids: **"One, two — eyes on you!"**

The Magic Box: any box with a lid. Chant it, shake it, sniff it, peek dramatically — the day's key prop lives inside.

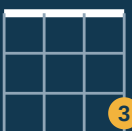
The two-tier rule: never make a little produce a sentence, and never let a big get away with one word.

Whisper → shout close: calms them down, then releases them — every single closing.

Teacher-fails-on-purpose: once a day, get it wrong and let them correct you — the correction shout is the loudest language of the day.

One song a week: same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole song on Friday.

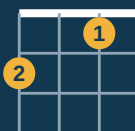
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G C E A

C

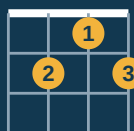
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G C E A

F

0



G C E A

G7

Uke quick-ref

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up ("round — and — blue-and"). Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the circle turning.

The song needs only **C · F · G7**.

MONDAY

Our Round Earth

Today's words: **Earth**

Grab: the **globe** in the Magic Box (the biggest one in the school — it has to fill your two hands); a low shelf or table where every child can reach it, because it stays out all week; the earth card; the picture cards from print pack page 11.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box is **heavy**, and whatever is inside it **rolls**. Hold it up with both hands, as if it might get away from you. Whole class chants:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Tip the box gently from side to side — something big and round rolls from one end to the other, twice. Now lift the lid a crack and **peek**, for a long time, and let your face go slowly amazed.

TEACHER "There is a whole **WORLD** in this box." (*lift the globe out with both hands, slowly, and hold it up above your head*)

Arms curved round an imaginary ball: **"Earth!"**

4 MIN TEACH · EARTH

Sit down with the globe in your lap. Turn it slowly, once, in silence, so everybody sees it go round. Then say it twice — the second time they say it with you:

My Earth is **round**, (*draw a big circle with both arms*)

My Earth is **blue**, (*one hand waves like water*)

Some of it is **green** — (*flat palm slaps the floor*)

and **I LIVE ON IT TOO!** (*both hands flat on your own chest*)

Now the globe goes right round the circle and **every child holds the whole world** in their own two hands. Nobody rushes. As each child takes it, say their name and the sentence: "*Yang Yang is holding the Earth.*"

LITTLES hug the globe and say **"Earth!"** **BIGS** owe you the frame: **"This is the Earth."** **"I live on the Earth."**

Teacher fails: take the globe back, tuck it under your arm like a football, put it on the floor and pull your foot back to **kick it**. "It's a ball, isn't it?" Freeze there. Wait for the shouting.

Chinese moment: lay the **earth** card under the globe and take **Earth** apart out loud — earth is the ground you are sitting on, ball is a ball. The ground... is a ball. Leave the card there; the row grows by one card a day.

3 MIN GAME · PASS THE EARTH

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Everybody sits in a close ring, knees touching. The globe starts in your hands.

TEACHER **"Two hands.** Take it... say it... pass it on." (*hand it to the child on your left, saying "Earth!" as you let go*)

Every child says **"Earth!"** at the moment the globe leaves their hands. Go round twice: once slowly, once as fast as you dare — and the second time, whoever drops it does not lose, the whole class shouts **"Catch the Earth!"** and it starts again.

This game is really about **two hands and care**. Say it once, plainly, at the start: "*We only have one of these.*" They will remember that sentence in three weeks when we do Earth Day.

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing in a ring round the globe. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Land... water... **THIS IS MY EARTH!**" (*flat palm down · wavy hand · both arms thrown round an enormous ball on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Me on the Map* (Joan Sweeney) — it starts in one child's bedroom and pulls back, page by page, all the way to the whole round Earth. Read it backwards on Friday and it works just as well.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY EARTH chorus → Monday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Round and blue, round and **F** green, **C** (*draw a big circle with both arms*)

F The best big **C** ball I've **G7** ever seen! **C** (*hug an imaginary globe*)

C Land and **F** water, water and **C** land, (*flat hand · wavy hand*)

F This is my **C** Earth — **G7** take my **C** hand! (*hold hands right round the circle*)

MONDAY · EARTH

C This is the Earth, my home, my home, (*both hands on your chest*)

G7 Round like a ball **C** wherever I roam! (*big circle, then walking fingers*)

The one song of the week — same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole thing on Friday. Chords and the full sheet are on the Song tab. Sing it standing in a ring holding hands, with the globe in the middle, every single day.

TUESDAY

Land Under My Feet

Today's words: **land** (*Earth comes back every day*)

Grab: a **jar of real soil** in the Magic Box, lid off — garden soil, not potting compost, and damp enough to smell; a shallow tray to tip a little of it into; a cloth for hands; yesterday's globe; the soil card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box is heavy again today, but this time nothing rolls and nothing rattles. Chant first:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it — a dull, soft, disappointing thud. Now lift the lid a crack and **sniff**, loudly, with your eyes shut. Sniff again. Open your eyes wide.

TEACHER "It smells like **rain**... and **the garden**... and **worms**." (*lift the jar out and hold it under one child's nose, then the next*)

Tip a little into the tray. Flat palm slapping the floor: "**Land!**"

4 MIN TEACH · LAND

Every child pushes **one finger** into the soil in the tray and rubs it between finger and thumb. Nobody wipes it off yet. Then, standing:

Land is under my **feet**, (*stamp twice, hard*)

Land is **brown** and land is **green**, (*rub your fingers · wiggle fingers upward like grass*)

I can **walk** and I can **dig**, (*march on the spot · dig with both hands*)

on the biggest land you've **SEEN!** (*arms flung as wide as they will go*)

Now back to the globe. Put one finger on a green-and-brown patch and say the plain true thing: **this** is land, and we are standing on some right now — under the floor, under the building, all the way down. Let them stamp once more to check it is still there.

LITTLES slap the floor and say "**Land!**" **BIGS** take the frame: "**I can walk on the land.**" "**The land is brown and green.**"

Teacher fails: put your finger firmly on the middle of the **blue** Pacific and announce, delighted, "*Look at all this beautiful land.*" Start planning your garden on it. Wait.

Chinese moment: the **soil** card joins earth under the globe — soil, the soil in the jar. Point out that earth (Monday) and soil (today) are family: one is the whole ground, one is the stuff it is made of.

3 MIN GAME · LAND OR WATER?

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" You hold the globe. Everybody has two ready gestures: flat palm down for land, one wavy hand for water.

TEACHER "Watch my finger... **land or water?**" (*spin the globe, stop it with one finger, and hold still*)

They shout one word and do the gesture. **LITTLES** get the gesture and one word — that is a full pass. **BIGS** answer in the frame: "**That is water.**" "**Is it land or water?**" asked back at you by a Big is the best thing that can happen all morning.

Land eight or ten times and let them notice, without being told, that your finger keeps landing in the **blue**. Don't explain it — save it. Tomorrow's whole lesson is why.

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing round the globe, hands still a bit dusty. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Land... water... THIS IS MY EARTH!" (*flat palm down · wavy hand · both arms thrown round an enormous ball on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Dirt: The Scoop on Soil* (Natalie M. Rosinsky) — two pages is plenty. Then wash hands together and let them tell you what the water goes brown with.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY EARTH** chorus → Tuesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Round and blue, round and **F** green, **C** (*draw a big circle with both arms*)

F The best big **C** ball I've **G7** ever seen! **C** (*hug an imaginary globe*)

C Land and **F** water, water and **C** land, (*flat hand · wavy hand*)

F This is my **C** Earth — **G7** take my **C** hand! (*hold hands right round the circle*)

TUESDAY · LAND

C Land is brown and land is green, (*rub your fingers · wiggle fingers up like grass*)

G7 I can walk **C** on the land I've seen! (*march on the spot, then arms wide*)

Sing this one **marching**, right round the room in a line, and come back to the circle on the last word. The verse is only C and G7; if the marching costs you the ukulele, put it down and let them stamp the beat.

WEDNESDAY

Water All Around

Today's words: **water** (*Earth · land come back*)

Grab: a clear **bowl of water with a little boat floating on it** in the Magic Box — carried flat, never shaken; a small jug; a real sponge; a towel **on the floor before the children sit down**; the globe; the water card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Carry the box in with both hands, absolutely level, walking far too slowly. Put it down as if it were made of glass. Then chant:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Do not shake it today. Say so: "I can't shake this one." Tilt it one centimetre — and everyone hears the slop. Lift the lid and look in, and let the light off the water move on your face.

TEACHER "There's a **SEA** in here... and something is **floating** on it." (*lift the bowl out with two hands and set it in the middle, boat still sailing*)

One wavy hand: "**Water!**"

4 MIN TEACH · WATER

Every child blows the boat once, across the bowl, and passes the blow on. Then, sitting:

Water, water, **blue** and **wide**, (*both hands wave apart, wider and wider*)

Pour it, pour it — watch it **slide**, (*pouring mime from high up*)

Fish can swim (*one hand swims past your face*)

and **BOATS CAN RIDE!** (*flat hand sails right across in front of you*)

Now the globe, turned so the great blue Pacific faces them, and held still. Say the plain true thing: **most** of our Earth is water. More blue than green. Spin it once and let them see the blue win.

LITTLES wave one hand and say "**Water!**" **BIGS** take the frame: "**Most of the Earth is water.**" "**Boats can ride on the water.**"

Teacher fails: spill a little on purpose and try to mop it up with the **earth card**, or with the boat. Look surprised when it doesn't work. Wait for somebody to fetch the sponge.

Chinese moment: the **water** card joins earth and soil — water. Draw the character in the spilt water with one finger while it is still wet: it looks like a little river with drops flying off it, which is exactly what it is.

3 MIN GAME · POUR AND MOP

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The towel is down. Jug on the left, bowl on the right, sponge in a dish, exactly as they will find it on the shelf.

TEACHER "Pour... **slowly**... stop. Now the sponge. Squeeze it out. **Next.**" (*do it once yourself, in silence, before anyone else touches it*)

Everybody gets a turn: pour a little, mop the drips, squeeze the sponge into the bowl. Nobody is told off for spilling — spilling is *how you find out you need the sponge*, and the sponge is the whole point. **LITTLES** pour with two hands on the jug. **BIGS** pour and then say what they did: "**I poured the water.**"

This game is Tray 3 — the jug, the bowl and the sponge go straight onto the shelf afterwards and stay there all week. A wet tray is the control of error: it tells the child they spilled without anybody saying a word.

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing round the bowl with the boat still floating. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Land... water... **THIS IS MY EARTH!**" (*flat palm down · wavy hand · both arms thrown round an enormous ball on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Water Is Water* (Miranda Paul) — water goes to cloud, to rain, to puddle, to ice and back. Leave the bowl out afterwards and see how much has gone by Friday.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY EARTH** chorus → Wednesday's verse → chorus**CHORUS**

C Round and blue, round and **F** green, **C** (*draw a big circle with both arms*)

F The best big **C** ball I've **G7** ever seen! **C** (*hug an imaginary globe*)

C Land and **F** water, water and **C** land, (*flat hand · wavy hand*)

F This is my **C** Earth — **G7** take my **C** hand! (*hold hands right round the circle*)

WEDNESDAY · WATER

C Water, water, **blue** and **wide**, (*both hands waving apart*)

G7 Fish can swim **C** and boats can ride! (*a swimming hand, then a sailing hand*)

Sing this verse sitting down, rocking side to side on the beat like a boat. It is the one verse of the week that should be slow.

THURSDAY

The Earth Is Home

Today's words: **home** (*Earth · land · water come back*)

Grab: the **Montessori sandpaper globe** in the Magic Box — rough land, smooth sea; the coloured globe beside it; a scarf to use as a blindfold, or just honest closed eyes; the home card; if you have them, a photo of each child's own home.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box makes a new noise. Chant, then turn the box slowly on its side — and something inside **scrapes**.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Do it again so they hear it properly: a dry, rough, scratchy drag. Put your ear right against the lid, then peek in for a long time.

TEACHER "It's another Earth... but this one you can **FEEL**." (*lift out the sandpaper globe and run one finger across Africa so everybody hears it*)

Both hands round a ball: "**Earth!**" Then hands on the chest: "**Home!**"

4 MIN TEACH · HOME

The sandpaper globe goes round the circle, and each child runs **one finger** over it. Rough is land. Smooth is sea. Nobody looks — they close their eyes to feel it. Then:

The Earth is **home** for you, (*point gently at one child*)

The Earth is **home** for me, (*both hands flat on your chest*)

For every **bird** and **bug** and **fish**, (*flap · wriggle one finger · swim one hand*)

and every single **TREE!** (*arms up and out like branches*)

Now name the year out loud: the chick, the caterpillar, the lion, the fish, the tree, the family — every single one lives **on this one ball**. There is nowhere else. If you have the photos, lay them in a ring round the globe: my home is on the Earth, and so is yours, and so is yours.

LITTLES put both hands on their chest and say "**Home!**" **BIGS** take the frame: "**The Earth is my home.**" "**I live on the Earth.**"

Teacher fails: announce, calmly, "*I live on the MOON,*" and point at the ceiling. Pack an imaginary bag. Wait to be marched back to the globe and put on it.

Chinese moment: the **home** card joins the row — the Earth is our home. Ask each child where is your home? and let them answer in either language; then put every answer's finger back on the same green patch of the globe.

3 MIN GAME · FEEL FOR LAND

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" One child at a time, eyes shut (scarf if they like it), both hands on the sandpaper globe.

TEACHER "Eyes closed. Feel... **rough or smooth?** Land or water?" (*guide their hand onto one place and hold it still*)

They say "**Land!**" or "**Water!**" — then open their eyes and check against the coloured globe standing beside it. Green under a rough finger, blue under a smooth one, every time. **BIGS** go one step further: "**It is rough, so it is land.**"

The **two globes agreeing** is the control of error, and it is why both of them live on Tray 1 all week. The child never needs you to say "correct" — the material already did.

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing in the ring, hands still joined from the song. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Land... water... **THIS IS MY EARTH!**" (*flat palm down · wavy hand · both arms thrown round an enormous ball on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Here We Are* (Oliver Jeffers) — notes for living on planet Earth, written by a father for his baby. Read the "people" page and the "look after it" page, and stop there; the rest keeps until Earth Day.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY EARTH** chorus → Thursday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Round and blue, round and **F** green, **C** (*draw a big circle with both arms*)

F The best big **C** ball I've **G7** ever seen! **C** (*hug an imaginary globe*)

C Land and **F** water, water and **C** land, (*flat hand · wavy hand*)

F This is my **C** Earth — **G7** take my **C** hand! (*hold hands right round the circle*)

THURSDAY · HOME

C Earth is home for you and me, (*point out · hands on chest*)

G7 For every bird **C** and every tree! (*flap slowly, then arms up like branches*)

Sing this one **quietly**, still holding hands, and let the last line ring out. It is the closest this song comes to a lullaby and they will drop their voices to match yours without being asked.

FRIDAY

Round and Round + Review

Today's words: **round** (and all five words together)

Grab: everything from the week back in the Magic Box — globe, soil jar, water bowl and boat, sandpaper globe; the big **blue-and-green handprint Earth** the class painted this week, dry and ready to go on the wall; the whole row of Chinese characters cards; the awards from print pack page 17.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box will barely shut. It is heavy, it rolls, it slops and it scrapes, all at once. Hold it up with a groan. Chant:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it very carefully — every sound of the week at the same time. Then open the lid all the way and tip your head in.

TEACHER "The whole week is in here." (*lift each thing out one at a time and set it in the middle: globe, soil, water, sandpaper globe*)

Last of all, unroll the class's own painted handprint Earth and hold it up. Arms round a ball: "Earth!"

4 MIN TEACH · ROUND + THE WHOLE WEEK

Stand up. The last word of the week is the shape of it:

Round, round Earth, (*draw the big circle with both arms*)

go **spin** around, (*everybody turns once, right round, on the spot*)

Land up high (*flat palm lifted over your head*)

and **SEA ALL ROUND!** (*both wavy hands sweep a huge circle round you*)

Then the review, out of the box, quick-fire — hold up one thing, they name it and give the gesture: globe → "Earth!" soil → "Land!" water → "Water!" sandpaper globe → "Home!" and the painted circle → "Round!" Round again, faster. Then once more with your eyes shut, which they find outrageous.

LITTLES five words, five gestures, no sentences. **BIGS** give a sentence for each: "The Earth is round." "Most of the Earth is water." "The Earth is my home."

Teacher fails: hold the globe up and say, quite firmly, "The Earth is **square**." Draw a square in the air. Refuse to be corrected for one whole beat, then let them win.

Chinese moment: read the whole row together — earth · soil · water · home · round — and add the last card, round. Then say what is coming: **Earth Day** is on 22 April, and it is the day everybody looks after Earth.

3 MIN GAME · PROP QUICK-FIRE REVIEW

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Everything from the week is back in the box. You pull one thing out at a time, fast, without looking.

TEACHER "What is it... and is it **land** or **water**?" (*hold the thing up high for one beat only, then hide it again*)

Soil, water, the boat, the sponge, a picture card off the shelf, the sandpaper globe. Two answers each time: the name, and land or water. **LITTLES** give the gesture. **BIGS** give the sentence and then take a turn as the teacher — one Big pulls the next thing out of the box and asks the class themselves.

Finish by hanging the class's **painted handprint Earth** on the wall, everybody watching, and put every single hand on it once as they go past. That is the display for the term, and they made all of it.

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing round the globe, under the painted Earth, awards in your hand. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Land... water... THIS IS MY EARTH!" (*flat palm down · wavy hand · both arms thrown round an enormous ball on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *The Earth Book* (Todd Parr) — one bright, simple, kind thing to do per page. Then hand out the awards and tell them Monday's news: next we find out what the land **does** — mountains, rivers, islands and lakes.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY EARTH** Friday's verse, then the WHOLE song, top to bottom

CHORUS

C Round and blue, round and **F** green, **C** (*draw a big circle with both arms*)

F The best big **C** ball I've **G7** ever seen! **C** (*hug an imaginary globe*)

C Land and **F** water, water and **C** land, (*flat hand · wavy hand*)

F This is my **C** Earth — **G7** take my **C** hand! (*hold hands right round the circle*)

FRIDAY · ROUND

C Round, round Earth, go spin around, (*everybody turns once on the spot*)

G7 Land up high **C** and sea all round! (*palm lifted high, then both hands sweep a circle*)

This run-through IS the week's review. Five verses, five words, five days, in order — Earth, land, water, home, round. You are not testing them; you are singing with them, and they are telling you everything they know.

★ This Is My Earth

Week 29 theme song
C (0003) · F (2010) · G7 (0212)

The one song of the week — sung at every circle. Same chorus daily, one new verse each morning, full song on Friday.

CHORUS — SING IT EVERY SINGLE DAY

- C** Round and blue, round and **F** green, **C** (draw a big circle with both arms)
F The best big **C** ball I've **G7** ever seen! **C** (hug an imaginary globe)
C Land and **F** water, water and **C** land, (flat hand · wavy hand)
F This is my **C** Earth — **G7** take my **C** hand! (hold hands right round the circle)

MONDAY · EARTH

- C** This is the Earth, my home, my home, (both hands on your chest)
G7 Round like a ball **C** wherever I roam! (big circle, then walking fingers)

TUESDAY · LAND

- C** Land is brown and land is green, (rub your fingers · wiggle fingers up like grass)
G7 I can walk **C** on the land I've seen! (march on the spot, then arms wide)

WEDNESDAY · WATER

- C** Water, water, blue and wide, (both hands waving apart)
G7 Fish can swim **C** and boats can ride! (a swimming hand, then a sailing hand)

THURSDAY · HOME

- C** Earth is home for you and me, (point out · hands on chest)
G7 For every bird **C** and every tree! (flap slowly, then arms up like branches)

FRIDAY · ROUND

- C** Round, round Earth, go spin around, (everybody turns once on the spot)
G7 Land up high **C** and sea all round! (palm lifted high, then both hands sweep a circle)

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up (“round — and — blue-and”).

Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the circle turning.

Practice this loop for five minutes tonight: **C** (4 strums) → **F** (4 strums) → **C** → **G7** → **C**. That is the entire chorus, and the whole song is those three shapes — **there is no Am this week at all**, so if last week's verses defeated you, this is the one to come back on. C is one finger, F is two, G7 is three; learn them in that order. If your fingers get stuck, put the uke down, put the globe in one child's hands to hold up for everybody, and do the finger-play instead: the class will not notice, and the actions carry the meaning either way.